

Paternal Ancestry of James Scott Wead III (1710–1929)

John Wade (c. 1710–1790)

- **c.1710:** Birth of John “Wade” Wead (surname also recorded as Wade/Waid). He was likely of Scots-Irish or English origin and settled on the colonial Pennsylvania frontier (Letterkenny Twp, near Rocky Spring in Franklin County) ¹ ² .
- **1758–1759:** Served in the French and Indian War as a provincial soldier. John’s 1760 will explicitly notes “money due me for my service in the Provincial Troops in years 1758 and 1759” ³ .
- **1760:** Drafted a will leaving his plantation near Rocky Spring Presbyterian Church to his son, Ebenezer Wead ⁴ . This bequest established the family’s roots by the Rocky Spring church, where John was a member of the early Presbyterian community.
- **Jan 1790:** John’s will was proven (18 July 1789 written; 25 Jan 1790 proved) in Franklin County ⁵ , marking his death around that time (age ~80). He was buried in the Rocky Spring churchyard. His tombstone epitaph, still preserved, cautions the living:

“Remember man that thou must die.” ⁶

(Gravestone of John Wade at Rocky Spring Presbyterian Church)

Ebenezer Wead (1748–1830)

- **1748:** Birth of Ebenezer Wead in Pennsylvania. He was John’s son and heir to the Rocky Spring plantation ⁴ . Ebenezer came of age amid the American Revolution era and married Margaret Henderson in 1780 (York County, PA), suggesting a Scots-Irish Presbyterian heritage like his father ⁷ .
- **1790s Migration:** After John’s death, Ebenezer headed west. By **1798** he had “entered” (claimed) land in the Northwest Territory, and in **1799** he arrived in Ohio ⁸ . One local history notes: “Ebenezer Wead came here from Lexington, Kentucky, in 1799. The year before he had entered fractional Section 24, in Van Buren Township, where he settled” ⁸ . He was among the first pioneers of the Dayton, Ohio area, establishing a farm in Van Buren Twp (south of Dayton).
- **Early Ohio Settlement:** Ebenezer’s farm prospered. By 1805 he purchased 80 acres near the site of the Dayton asylum and eventually expanded his holdings to 320 acres ⁹ . He was joined in Ohio by at least two sons, John and Robert Wead, and likely brought his younger son **James** (born 1790) as well ¹⁰ ⁸ . The family’s move from PA → KY → OH typified the post-Revolution westward expansion.
- **28 Aug 1830:** Death of Ebenezer Wead at age 81. He died in Montgomery County, Ohio and was buried in Beavertown Cemetery (Van Buren Twp) ¹¹ . His legacy as an early settler is noted in Dayton histories, though his name was sometimes spelled “Wade” in records. Ebenezer’s children—including his son James—carried the family into Ohio’s statehood era.

James Wead (1790–1873)

- **1790:** Birth of James Wead, likely in Pennsylvania shortly before the family's migration west ¹² . He grew up on the Ohio frontier in a pioneering household. In October 1812, during the War of 1812, James married **Elizabeth Winter** in Xenia, Greene County, Ohio ¹³ , uniting two early Ohio families. They settled as farmers in Greene County (near Massie's Creek).
- **War of 1812:** James served as a private in Captain Schuyler's company of the 29th U.S. Infantry. For this service, he earned a **320-acre bounty land grant** in Illinois, issued under the name "James Wade" and signed by President James Monroe in 1817 ¹⁴ . (The patent text identifies him as "late a private in Schuyler's Company, 29th U.S. Infantry," confirming James Wead's war record despite the slight spelling variation ¹⁵ .) He never moved to Illinois, instead selling the land, but the reward highlights his contribution in the war.
- **Mid-1800s Life:** James and Elizabeth raised a large family (at least five children to adulthood) on their Greene County farm ¹⁶ ¹⁷ . He is remembered in local history as an early settler and War of 1812 veteran, appearing in pioneer rolls and veterans' lists ¹⁸ ¹⁹ . He was a typical civic-minded farmer, serving as juror, estate executor, and road overseer in his community – with no records of any conflicts, indicating a peaceable, respected life ²⁰ ²¹ .
- **1866:** In his twilight years, James penned a personal letter to his son **John Steele Wead** (then in Illinois). This 1866 letter (still preserved by the family) affectionately mentioned "Robert's farm" and conveyed fatherly guidance ²² . Such correspondence offers a touching glimpse of James as a caring patriarch connecting with his Civil War veteran son after the war.
- **1873:** James Wead died in 1873 in Greene County, Ohio, nearly age 83 ²³ . He was buried alongside his wife Elizabeth at Stevenson Cemetery (Massie's Creek) near Wilberforce ¹⁶ . His grave and an estate handled by a neighbor reflect the esteem he earned in his community ¹⁶ ¹⁹ . James's long life spanned the frontier era through the Civil War – a bridge between the pioneer generation and the post-war Midwest.

John Steele Wead (1836–1904)

- **11 Jun 1836:** Birth of John Steele Wead, in or near Xenia, Ohio ²⁴ . He was the youngest son of James and Elizabeth Wead. The middle name "Steele" likely honored a family friend or maternal relative (possibly Dr. John Steele of Dayton) ²⁵ . John grew up in Ohio but, like many of his generation, ventured further west as a young man. By the late 1850s, he had relocated to Illinois in search of new opportunities ²⁶ .
- **Civil War (1861–1862):** At age 25, John S. Wead enlisted in the Union Army soon after the Civil War began. He mustered in as a private in Company E, **66th Illinois Volunteer Infantry** in August 1861 ²⁷ . This unit (the Western Sharpshooters) fought in the Western Theater of the war. John saw action in Missouri at the **Battle of Mount Zion** (Dec 1861), and in early 1862 he fought in Tennessee at **Fort Donelson** and **Shiloh** ²⁸ . During the grueling Fort Donelson campaign, he fell ill from exposure; by June 1862 he was discharged for disability, his health broken by the war ²⁹ . He had "served his country well," but at the cost of lasting injury.
- **Post-War Life:** After recuperating, John settled in Illinois. On Dec 24, 1863, he married **Phoebe Butler** in Coles County, IL ³⁰ . They made their home in Edgar County, Illinois – near the town of **Paris** – and raised a family of five children (though two daughters died young) ³¹ . John engaged in farming and later business, becoming a **respected citizen** of Paris. In his later years (by the 1890s), he spent time in Galesburg, Illinois, likely to be near some of his adult children. He remained devout (joining the Methodist Church) and active in veterans' affairs, proud of his Union service ³² .

- **1904:** John Steele Wead died in 1904 in Illinois. A local obituary paid warm tribute to his character, calling him “a respected citizen,” “devoted to home and family,” and “gentle, kind, [the] ideal citizen.” This memorial portrait of John – as an upstanding, kind-hearted family man – endured in the community’s memory ³³. He was also remembered for his faith and civic involvement (indicative of an “**ideal citizen**” of his era). John was laid to rest likely in Paris, IL, closing the chapter on a life that spanned the pioneer epoch through the dawn of the 20th century.

Dr. James Scott Wead (1868–1929)

- **25 Mar 1868:** Birth of James Scott Wead (great-grandfather of James III) in Paris, Illinois ³⁴. He was the son of John Steele Wead and Phoebe (Butler) Wead. Growing up in post-Civil War Illinois, James S. Wead benefited from his family’s pioneer legacy and also their emphasis on education.
- **Education & Early Career:** James pursued higher education in both pharmacy and medicine. He attended the **Chicago College of Pharmacy**, graduating in 1891, and then earned his medical degree at the **College of Physicians and Surgeons in Keokuk, Iowa** in 1894 ³⁵. Shortly after, on **Nov 3, 1894**, he married **Alma Jane Trimmer**, a fellow physician from Stark County, IL (they had been classmates in Keokuk) ³⁶. This marriage made James and Alma one of the region’s earliest husband-and-wife doctor teams – a remarkable partnership in the 1890s.
- **Medical Practice in Illinois:** Dr. James Wead practiced briefly in Arcola, IL (1894–95) and then set up a medical practice in Stark County. By 1900 he settled in the town of **Wyoming, Illinois** (Stark Co.), where he would practice medicine for the next 29 years ³⁵ ³⁷. He purchased a local drug store and even formed a business partnership, reflecting his dual training as physician and pharmacist. For decades, “Dr. James and Dr. Alma Wead” were beloved fixtures of Wyoming, making house calls together and caring for the community. They had two sons: **Dr. John T. Wead** (born 1896, who later joined his parents’ practice) and **James Kerr Wead** (born 1907, who pursued a business career) ³⁶. Alma continued to practice alongside James until his death, exemplifying a family devoted both to medicine and to each other.
- **Civic Leadership:** Beyond his busy medical practice, Dr. Wead was deeply involved in civic affairs. He held various local offices and notably served as **president of the Wyoming high school and grade school board** ³⁸ ³⁹. He was passionate about public education and community health. In **1902**, he **co-founded the Stark County Medical Society** and served as its first president ³⁸ ³⁹ – helping to organize his fellow physicians for professional development and public health initiatives. Patients and neighbors knew him not only as their doctor but as a civic leader who could always be counted on.
- **16 May 1929:** Dr. James S. Wead passed away at age 61, at his home in Wyoming, IL ⁴⁰ ³⁹. His death was widely mourned. Newspaper tributes praised him as a community pillar – a skilled physician who had ministered to local families for nearly three decades, a former school board president who improved local education, and a leader in county medical circles. Above all, he was remembered as a **devoted husband** to Dr. Alma and a man of high character. Alma, who was at his side in both work and life, was “heartbroken” at his passing ⁴¹. Dr. Wead’s funeral was a testament to his impact: patients, colleagues, and friends alike paid respects to a man who had been *family doctor, civic leader*, and the patriarch of the Wead family. With his death in 1929, this direct paternal line – from John Wade (1710s) to James S. Wead – came to a close in the earthly sense, spanning over two centuries of family legacy.

Sources: Family letters and wills; Rocky Spring Presbyterian Church records ⁶ ⁵; Franklin Co. (PA) Will Book A ⁴²; *Pioneer Life in Dayton...* (J. F. Edgar, 1896) ⁸; Montgomery & Greene Co. (OH) histories ⁸ ¹⁸;

War of 1812 U.S. bounty land warrant (Illinois) ¹⁴ ; Illinois State Archives (War of 1812 service) ¹⁵ ; *History of Stark County, IL*; Wead family documents and oral history ²² ³⁸ ; Findagrave memorials ¹¹ ¹⁶ .

¹ ¹⁰ ²⁵ ²⁶ ²⁷ ⁴¹ DRAFT_001.docx

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<https://mcconnell.com/html/d0010/g0000069.html>

³ ⁴ ⁷ ¹² ¹³ ²⁴ ³⁰ ³¹ ³² Family Tree of James Scott Wead III with Origins and Historical Context.docx

https://pgcarchive-my.sharepoint.com/personal/legalhoa_pgcarchive_onmicrosoft_com/_layouts/15/Doc.aspx?sourcedoc=%7B2C9974DB-BF24-45EF-BA4F20CB2FFCCB3%7D&file=Family%20Tree%20of%20James%20Scott%20Wead%20III%20with%20Origins%20and%20Historical%20Context.docx&action=download

⁶ Full text of "History of the Rocky Spring Church : and addresses delivered at the centennial anniversary of the present church edifice, August 23, 1894"

https://archive.org/stream/historyofrockysp00wyli/historyofrockysp00wyli_djvu.txt

⁸ ⁹ Pioneer Life in Dayton and Vicinity

<http://www.daytonhistorybooks.citymax.com/page/page/1525915.htm>

¹¹ Ebenezer Wead (1748-1830) - Memorials - Find a Grave

<https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/144500090/wead>

¹⁴ ¹⁵ James Wade.docx

https://pgcarchive-my.sharepoint.com/personal/legalhoa_pgcarchive_onmicrosoft_com/_layouts/15/Doc.aspx?sourcedoc=%7BF9526F98-7E6F-4CF5-86F0-F0A8C33162F3%7D&file=James%20Wade.docx&action=default&mobileredirect=true

¹⁶ ¹⁷ ¹⁸ ¹⁹ ²⁰ ²¹ ²⁸ ²⁹ ³³ Historical Records of James Wead.docx

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²² Wead family in Van Buren Twp Ohio

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/>

²³ James Wead (1790-1873) - Find a Grave Memorial

<https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/13655182/james-wead>

³⁴ Dr James Scott Wead (1868-1929) - Find a Grave Memorial

<https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/52786821/james-scott-wead>

³⁵ ³⁶ ³⁷ ³⁸ ⁴⁰ Dr Wead info.docx

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³⁹ Dr Wead.docx

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